

MEASURE	2021	2025	CHANGE	
STAY INTENTIONS				
Overall	73%*	75.8%²⁰²⁴	+2.8 pp	▲
By region				
International students from Africa	72.5%*	86.5%²⁰²⁴	+14.0 pp	▲
International students from the Americas	60.1%*	69.3%²⁰²⁴	+9.2 pp	▲
International students from Asia	79%*	80%²⁰²⁴	+1.0 pp	▲
International students from Europe	67.4%*	66.4%²⁰²⁴	-1.0 pp	▼
International students from the Middle East	58%*	55.3%²⁰²⁴	-2.7 pp	▼
By field				
International students studying computing	87.4%	89.8%²⁰²⁴	+2.4 pp	▲
International students studying engineering	85.2%	89.5%²⁰²⁴	+4.3 pp	▲
International students studying mathematics	74.8%	81.7%²⁰²⁴	+6.9 pp	▲
International students studying the physical sciences	81.9%	87.2%²⁰²⁴	+5.4 pp	▲
REALIZED RETENTION				
Five-year stay rate	70.8%*	73.4%²⁰²³	+2.6 pp	▲
Ten-year stay rate	64.7%*	67.8%²⁰²³	+3.1 pp	▲
CAREER PATHS AFTER THE PHD				
US citizens: academe	39.9%*	42.5%²⁰²⁴	+2.6 pp	▲
US citizens: industry or business	33.8%*	32.2%²⁰²⁴	-1.6 pp	▼
Temporary visa holders: academe	24.8%*	32.2%²⁰²⁴	+7.4 pp	▲
Temporary visa holders: industry or business	69.4%*	60.9%²⁰²⁴	-8.5 pp	▼
WORK-VISA BRIDGE				
STEM OPT applications received	5,940*	22,300	3.75×	▲
STEM OPT applications approved	5,990*	18,700	3.13×	▲
H-1B approvals: tech occupations	106,000*	85,100	-19.8%	▼
IMMIGRATION PATHWAYS AND BOTTLENECKS				
EB-2 green-card wait for Indian nationals	10y 6m*	12y 5m	+2y	▲
EB-2 green-card wait for Chinese nationals	3y 10m*	4y 8m	+9 mo	▲
EB-2 green-card wait for all other nationalities	2y 10m*	4y 6m	+1y 8m	▲
ESTIMATED LOSS FROM DEPARTING STEM TALENT				
FIELD	NO. DEPARTING	SHARE DEPARTING	MONEY LOST	
Engineering	4,400	29%	\$1.52B	
Life, health, and agricultural sciences	3,100	30%	\$1.15B	
Physical sciences	2,200	35%	\$0.712B	
Computer and math sciences	1,300	24%	\$0.449B	

* Data are available further back than 2021 for marked series.

Note: Historical comparisons use 2021 and 2025 observations. Superscript years mark rows with an earlier latest endpoint than 2025. Estimated money lost = departures × field-specific time to degree × \$53,000 annual NSF GRFP support.

Source: Derived from Figures 6.01-6.07; Tables 6.01-6.04.